SPL Program Comparison

Red Rocks Amphitheatre vs Hollywood Bowl · reference for Fountain Square low-frequency / neighbor compliance
Prepared 2026-06-15 · Tiny Door Studios / 3CDC

Side-by-Side Restrictions

Aspect	Red Rocks Amphitheatre	Hollywood Bowl
Operator / program	Denver Arts & Venues; engineered by **K2 Audio** (Boulder) over a multi-year, data-driven project	LA Philharmonic / County of Los Angeles; long-standing operational limits
Setting	~9,500-seat mountain amphitheater; nearest homes ~1 mile away in Morrison; bedrock transmits sub-bass	~17,500-seat hillside amphitheater; residential homes on the surrounding hills
Broadband A-weighted limit	**108 dBA**, 1-minute average (tightens to **~105 dBA** after a set late hour)	**95 dBA**
Broadband C-weighted limit	— (uses a dedicated band metric instead, see below)	**108 dBC** (controls bass) → +13 dB over the A limit
Per-band Leq ceiling	**123 dB** in any frequency band, 1-minute average	—
Low-frequency metric	**“dB1” custom band: 125 dB over 25–80 Hz**, 1-minute average, applies after a designated hour — built specifically for the sub-bass neighbor complaints	Folded into the broadband 108 dBC (no isolated sub band)
Averaging window	1-minute Leq for all metrics	Leq-style; exact window not publicly published *
Measurement position	**Front-of-house mix position** (real-time, engineer-facing) + some off-site sensing	Operational at the venue; position not publicly detailed *
Basis of the limits	FOH limits **derived by K2 to correlate with off-site impact** through years of data	Fixed paired A + C ceiling
Time-of-night tiers	**Yes** — limits tighten late; dB1 band engages after a set hour	Curfew only (no tiered level reduction documented)
Curfew	11:45 PM weeknights / 12:30 AM weekends & holidays	11:00 PM Mon–Sat / 10:30 PM Sun
Enforcement	Auto-email to consultant + venue on exceedance; **3 exceedances** → **$10,000** (another $10k per next 3); curfew **$10,000 per half-hour** past the 3rd minute	Self-managed / contractual (no published fine schedule)
Logging / tuning	Per-second logs retained; **protocols refined annually** from the data	Not publicly detailed
Genre context	All genres; EDM/bass acts drove the low-frequency rules	Primarily orchestral (LA Phil home) + summer all-genre season

* Hollywood Bowl publishes the 95 dBA / 108 dBC pair, curfew, and dual-weighting intent, but not its averaging window, meter location, or an enforcement-fine schedule. Red Rocks' program is far more fully documented.

All Measured Metrics

Red Rocks	Hollywood Bowl
• Broadband **dBA**, 1-min Leq (108, tightening to ~105 late) • **Per-band Leq**, 1-min (123 dB any band) • **dB1** low-frequency band, 25–80 Hz, 1-min (125 dB, time-gated) • Curfew clock + exceedance counter (3-strikes)	• Broadband **dBA** (95) • Broadband **dBC** (108) • Curfew clock

Which Fits Fountain Square

Red Rocks' framework is the better template — but borrow its structure, not its numbers. Both venues are giant amphitheaters running 95–108 dBA at the desk; Fountain Square will never run or be allowed near those levels. Your ceiling is set by Cincinnati's DD-zone ordinance (~75 dBA at the receiving property line), not an amphitheater FOH limit, so the absolute decibel values from either program do not transfer. The value is in the method.

Red Rocks fits your problem almost point-for-point: (1) a **dedicated low-frequency band (25–80 Hz)** — exactly the band metric you can add in Smaart, and the energy that actually travels into the Westin, Davidson and the restaurants; (2) **time-of-night tiers** — essential with hotels full of sleeping guests downtown; (3) **FOH limits derived to correlate with the property line** — your virtual-offset cards already do this translation; (4) **per-second logging used to tune the limits over time** — the 'watch a few shows, then set the number' approach; and (5) a **three-strikes counter**, already live in your dashboard. It is genre-robust, which matters because you run everything.

Hollywood Bowl's model is simpler and worth one borrow: a single **always-on paired A + C broadband limit** makes a clean, low-effort backstop. But its broadband dBC is a blunter low-frequency control than Red Rocks' isolated 25–80 Hz band, and as a self-policed classical home venue it is less suited to your all-genre, complaint-exposed, multi-neighbor reality.

> **Bottom line for FSQ:** adopt the Red Rocks structure — isolated 25–80 Hz band metric + time-of-night tiers + FOH-to-property-line mapping + log-then-set tuning + 3-strikes — scaled to your ~75 dBA property-line reality, with a simple paired broadband A/C limit as the easy backstop.

Sources: Denver Westword (Red Rocks 2015 regulations); AVIXA & Conscious Electronic (K2 Audio buildout, dB1 25–80 Hz band); Environmental Noise Control (Hollywood Bowl 95 dBA / 108 dBC); LA County Parks / Hollywood Bowl curfew. Some Hollywood Bowl operational details are not publicly published.